

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



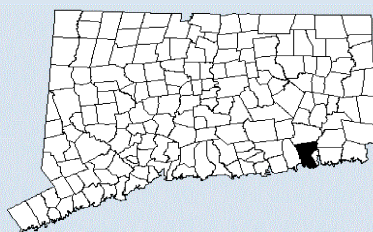
Waterford School District

Mr. Thomas Giard III, Superintendent • 860-444-5801 • www.waterfordschools.org

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	10
Enrollment	2,348
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$20,852
Total Expenditures ¹	\$53,129,887

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.5
Male	1,195	50.9	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	7	0.3	0.3
Asian	120	5.1	5.1
Black or African American	54	2.3	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	300	12.8	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	9	0.4	0.1
Two or More Races	130	5.5	4.3
White	1,728	73.6	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	87	3.7	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	639	27.2	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	400	17.0	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	28	2.3
Male	128	11.0	63	5.1
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	*	*	6	10.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	59	20.1	21	6.3
White	155	9.2	57	3.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	20	20.6	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	128	19.6	46	6.5
Students with Disabilities	75	19.5	31	6.5
District	246	10.8	91	3.7
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 328

Number of school-based arrests: 8

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	174.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	7.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	31.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	74.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	4.5
School Level	11.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	5.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	10.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	19.7
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	94.4

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.8	1.3
Black or African American	4	1.6	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5	2.0	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	243	95.7	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.4	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	*	27	96.4
White	132	91.7	145	93.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	42	85.7	41	91.1
Students with Disabilities	22	73.3	40	80.0
District	169	91.8	198	93.8
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	36	67.9
Emotional Disturbance	7	28.0
Intellectual Disability	7	*
Learning Disability	130	94.9
Other Health Impairment	62	79.5
Other Disabilities	9	32.1
Speech/Language Impairment	25	96.2
District	276	76.2
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	59	2.4	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	25	1.0	1.1
Intellectual Disability	15	0.6	0.6
Learning Disability	137	5.7	6.1
Other Health Impairment	78	3.2	3.3
Other Disabilities	44	1.8	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	33	1.4	1.9
All Disabilities	391	16.2	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	30	7.7	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	19	4.9	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$33,101,666	\$12,991	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$3,899,537	\$1,661	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$1,566,679	\$668	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$2,350,251	\$1,001	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$2,267,862	\$966	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$793,102	\$338	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$5,873,433	\$2,503	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$2,273,121	\$1,046	\$1,287
Food services	\$39,233	\$17	\$28
Enterprise operations	\$965,002	\$411	\$170
Total	\$53,129,887	\$20,852	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$5,078,626	38.8	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,990,678	15.2	10.8
Other Salaries	\$289,937	2.2	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$2,255,727	17.2	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$565,278	4.3	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$2,271,198	17.4	22.6
Supplies	\$16,969	0.1	0.6
Property Services	\$23,814	0.2	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$519,209	4.0	6.3
Equipment	\$4,040	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$62,525	0.5	0.1
Total	\$13,078,000	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.6	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	94.7
State	1.5
Federal	3.5
Tuition & Other	0.3

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	54	75.3	54	76.2	26	75.1
Black or African American	30	66.4	30	57.7	14	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	140	61.4	140	58.3	55	63.2
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	76	66.3	76	59.9	34	66.6
White	931	70.5	926	66.0	416	66.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	73	62.1	73	59.9	30	62.7
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,162	69.8	1,157	65.2	518	67.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	366	63.6	363	57.9	155	61.7
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	869	71.7	867	67.9	393	68.8
Students with Disabilities	207	51.3	204	44.1	91	49.0
Students without Disabilities	1,028	72.9	1,026	69.1	457	70.3
High Needs	510	61.1	506	55.9	219	59.2
Non-High Needs	725	75.1	724	71.2	329	71.8
District	1,235	69.3	1,230	64.9	548	66.8

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	79.4	84.4	92.5	90.3	702	86.9
Curl Up	87.5	79.4	83.9	89.8	702	85.0
Push Up	81.3	79.4	81.2	87.5	702	82.3
Mile Run/PACER	76.3	65.0	70.4	83.0	702	73.5
All Tests - District	55.0	47.8	62.4	71.6	702	59.3
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	8	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	26	92.3
White	164	93.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	70	82.9
Students with Disabilities	35	74.3
District	216	92.1
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	96.4	113	57.4
Male	88.4	89	44.9
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino	91.1	22	48.9
White	93.6	156	52.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	93.6	30	31.9
Students with Disabilities	68.8	8	10.0
District	92.4	202	51.1
State	95.0		43.5

³ Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	82.2	93.6
Male	67.3	79.4
Non-Binary	N/A	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	66.7	*
White	75.8	88.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61.7	75.0
Students with Disabilities	48.3	*
District	74.6	87.2
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	69.3	75	46.2	50	92.4	64.2
	High Needs Students	61.1	75	40.8	50	81.5	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	64.9	75	43.3	50	86.6	58.6
	High Needs Students	55.9	75	37.3	50	74.6	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	66.8	75	44.5	50	89.0	61.4
	High Needs Students	59.2	75	39.5	50	78.9	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	63.4%	100%	63.4	100	63.4	60.4%
	High Needs Students	60.5%	100%	60.5	100	60.5	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	74.3%	100%	74.3	100	74.3	65.2%
	High Needs Students	66.5%	100%	66.5	100	66.5	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	71.9%	100%	35.9	50	71.9	64.9%
	Oral	67.9%	100%	34.0	50	67.9	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	10.8%	<=5%	38.5	50	77.0	23.7%
	High Needs Students	19.0%	<=5%	22.1	50	44.1	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	92.9%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	51.1%	75%	34.1	50	68.2	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		95.3%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		92.1%	94%	98.0	100	98.0	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		88.6%	94%	94.2	100	94.2	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		74.6%	75%	99.5	100	99.5	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		95.9% 59.3%	75%	39.5	50	79.0	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		50.5%	60%	42.0	50	84.1	52.4%
Accountability Index				1154.0	1450	79.6	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.1	13.9	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	71.2	55.9	15.3	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	71.8	59.2	12.7	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	88.6%	5.4%	10.2%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.6
	High Needs Students	99.2
Math	All Students	99.3
	High Needs Students	98.5
Science	All Students	98.9
	High Needs Students	97.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 59.7

State: 49.7

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Waterford is in its fifth year of Strategic Coherence Plan, school growth plans for each school with goals on academics and social-emotional learning. An audit of the existing Strategic Plan has been implemented with subcommittees formed to revise the plan. The three-year plan will focus on:

-Communication and Alignment. -Higher Order Thinking Skills and Assessment. -Social Emotional Learning. -Equity.

Waterford continues to execute the Professional Learning Community (PLC) program with our staff. The PLC program requires that staff work in grade level or subject area teams to discuss and analyze student data from common district or State assessments.

There is a Professional Learning and Evaluation Committee comprised of teachers that helps refine our evaluation plan and assists in setting the direction of professional learning.

Curriculum Leaders, Department Chairs, and Instructional Coaches in Literacy, Numeracy and Technology continue to work with their groups on common goals and instructional strategies centered on implementing the Common Core State Standards. By meeting regularly, these groups have an opportunity to discuss what works or what doesn't and improve upon it.

The district has made an effort to assist those students who are not identified as special education but are also not at the proficient level. We have Literacy and Mathematics Support Teachers in each of our elementary schools and our middle school that focus on reading and math. Waterford High School offers support classes in reading, mathematics and writing for those students that need assistance.

Special Education services are delivered through cooperatively taught classes as well as some self-contained skill-based classes at Waterford High School and Clark Lane Middle School. Our elementary schools continue to provide integrated Special Education services, with a focus on the provision of related services in the general education settings as well. We offer Explorers programs at each level which provide individualized programming for students with highly specialized needs. Our Special Education staff has focused on reading and literacy, with an emphasis on training in research-based programs which include Wilson Language, Orton-Gillingham, Read Naturally and the EdMark Reading Program. We have also added a therapeutic day program for some high-needs students at Waterford High School.

Parental outreach has continued to grow in our district. Each school has specific social media handles for their schools, so parents are able to see day by day what is happening at each school. Our district website lists all community and school activities, and ways for parents to become involved. The District has instituted a Thursday Reminders email program for consistent communication to all families and staff. All School Messenger emails are now translated in four languages: Chinese, Korean, Spanish, and Urdu. A dedicated district email address has been established for parents to address all questions and concerns.

Waterford Public Schools is increasing the continuum of services that are provided in the District. We have increased our ability to service students with the addition of a community partnership with UCFS by introducing two school-based health clinics for medical and counseling needs located at Clark Lane Middle School and Waterford High School.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Respecting cultural, racial, and economic differences remains a priority for our schools. Our District Equity Team has met for its second year. The District Equity Team has formed four subcommittees to write a District Equity Plan to be embedded into the District Strategic Plan. Our School Equity Teams continue to meet and carry forward the training and learning to school staff.

Our elementary District Equity Team representatives collaborated with an equity liaison through LEARN to advance our focus on equity by expanding classroom libraries and materials that convey varied perspectives for students to explore and think critically.

Waterford continues to offer our students the opportunity to attend various high schools in the region. Transportation is provided to the following schools, the Agricultural Science and Technology program at Ledyard High School, Grasso Technical High School and Norwich Regional Technical High School.

Waterford High School continues to partner with three K-8 school systems as a school of choice for their high school students.

The District has launched a one-to-one device program. The goal of the one-to-one device program is to promote the use of technology to enhance the educational program for all students and provide equitable access to technology.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

It is the policy of the Board of Education and the practice of the school system that resources are allocated equally among all schools. Each elementary school teaches the same curriculum and uses the same adopted texts and resources. Each school budget is developed through a formula based on the number of classes and students in the school.

Technology resources are distributed equally among the schools in the district according to a technology plan approved by the State of Connecticut. Each of our elementary schools has been designed the same, with each school having the same number of interactive whiteboards, computers, and computer labs. The elementary schools have just about equal populations due to Waterford's redistricting from five to three elementary schools, which was done to achieve more equity across the schools.

Each principal oversees the distribution of resources in their school. The Director of Finance & Operations and the Assistant Superintendent also look at each school and the district as a whole to ensure resources are allocated equally. Class sizes are monitored and adjusted at the district level, ensuring equality across grades and schools.